

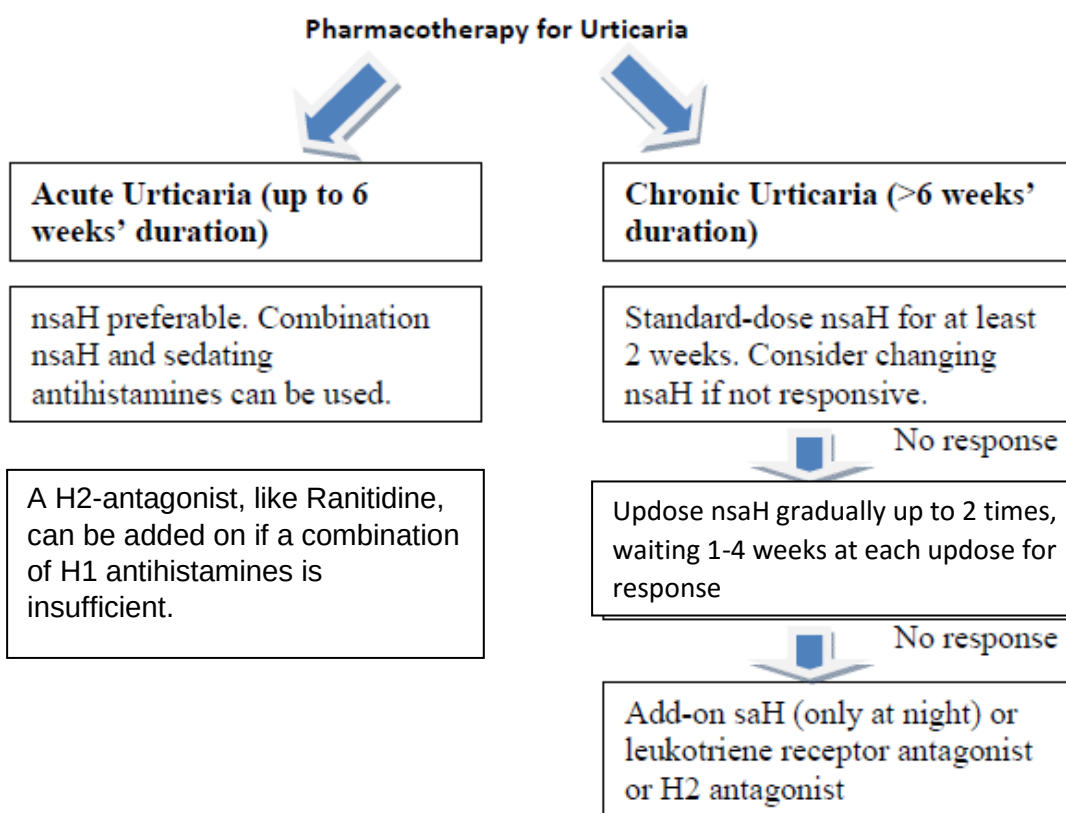
GUIDELINE FOR THE MANAGEMENT OF URTICARIA

Urticaria is defined by the presence of wheals and/or angioedema.

Urticaria management comprises 2 essential steps:

1. Identification and elimination of eliciting triggers
2. Treatment aimed at providing symptom relief

The drug of choice in children 6 months to 2 years of age is Cetirizine. Nonsedating antihistamines (nsaH) are preferable, especially in chronic urticaria.



5. Follow-up for Urticaria from Children's Emergency/Outpatient clinics

Patients should be seen in the Paediatric Allergy Clinics in 4-6 weeks.

However, if the patient has refractory chronic urticaria, an earlier review should be obtained to optimize the management.

Given the alternatives, steroids are not usually indicated in the treatment of acute idiopathic urticaria.

DOSES

Drug active component (brand) Name	Age category	Dose
Cetirizine (Zyrtec)	6 months – 2 years	2.5 mg daily
	2-5 years	5 mg daily
	5 years and above	10 mg daily
Fexofenadine (Telfast)	6 -23 months	15 mg bd
	2-11 years	30 mg bd
	12 years and above	120 mg daily
Chlorpheniramine (Piriton)	2 years and older	0.1 mg/kg tds, max 4mg per dose. Given the potential sedative effects, use once nightly if intending to combine with an nsaH
Hydroxyzine (Atarax)	2 years and older	0.5-2 mg tds or qds, max 100mg per dose Given the potential sedative effects, use once nightly if intending to combine with an nsaH